

Week 26: Falsehood

BIG IDEA

This lesson answers the atheist objection that an all-powerful, all-good God would have prevented evil. There are some things God cannot do, like contradict himself or lie, and he did not create evil. He has morally justified reasons for allowing it temporarily, even though we only see in part.

KEY POINTS FROM THE LEADER VIDEO

- The lesson responds to a common atheist objection: if God is so powerful and good, he would have prevented evil from the start.
- In a debate, an atheist argued God should have made a 'God-world' of only God-like objects with no suffering or evil.
- That fails: a world where everything equals God means God is no longer God, collapsing into a form of pantheism.
- Being all-powerful does not mean God can do anything; God cannot contradict himself or lie, and he did not create evil.
- God is not responsible for evil, and while he works to remedy it, he must allow us free will to make our own choices.
- God has morally justified reasons for allowing evil's temporary existence; as Paul says in 1 Corinthians, we only see things in part right now.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. What are some things it is actually impossible for God to do, and what do those limits show about his nature?
2. If God did not create evil, why does he allow it, even for a time?
3. What good can come from evil? Brainstorm examples together.
4. How can we look to God for hope instead of doubting him because of the evil around us?

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